

The Book of Mormon (2st Half)

Religion A 122 Fall 2026

Instructor: Robbie Taggart

Email: robbie.taggart@byu.edu **Office:** JSB 316T

Office Hours: M/W 10-10:50am **or by appointment**

Text: The Book of Mormon & online readings

TAs: Josh Eddington (jedd12@student.byu.edu)

Elias Tucker (elias.tucker@byu.edu)



Course Summary

Together, we will engage in a joyful, curious, meaningful study of the second half of the Book of Mormon (Alma 30 – Moroni 10). We will examine the literary, theological, and historical elements of this sacred text and seek to become more hopeful and deliberate disciples of Jesus Christ through our experience. I hope you will gain a deeper appreciation of the beauty, complexity, and richness of the Book of Mormon and be empowered to teach scripture to others with passion, humility, and joy. All assignments, papers, and tests for this course will be available in and submitted through BYU's online Learning Suite (LS) <https://learningsuite.byu.edu>.

Grades

I hope this class becomes more meaningful than a grade. That said, your grade is based on 1,000 possible points as shown to the right. I will adjust grades so the average class GPA will not be lower than 3.4 at the end of the semester.

Exams count for a little less than one third of your grade. Many points come from consistent engagement in the categories listed below (which are all designed to invite light into your life). Attendance and participation quizzes will open at class time and require a password. These close at 2:10 PM on the day of class. For reading, deepening study, and Creative Discipleship projects, you will enter scores in the appropriate class preparation quiz (under the LS Exam tab) by the beginning of each class. You may turn in preparation quizzes late, but there is a 25% penalty to encourage you to be consistent as you account for each class's preparation. **You may want to set a reminder or an alarm!**

GRADE	POINTS
A	930-1000
A-	900-929
B+	870-899
B	830-869
B-	800-829
C+	770-799
C	730-769
C-	700-729
D+	670-699
D	630-669
D-	600-629
E	0-599

	Grading Category	#	Points for Each	Total
You enter these into Learning Suite	Attendance and Participation (<i>8 points per class</i>)	27 class scores. We drop the lowest.	8	208
	Pre-Class Readings (<i>up to 4 points per class</i>)		4	104
	Deepening Study Activities (<i>one per class – 2 points</i>)		2	52
	One Salient Question (<i>one per class – 1 point</i>)		1	26
	Creative Discipleship Project time (<i>1/2 hour per class = 2 points</i>)		2	52
We grade these	Inspired Question Paper	1	110	110
	Random TA Grades for Deepening Study Activity	2	20	40
	Creative Discipleship Proposal	1	3	3
	Creative Discipleship Project Final	1	85	85
	Midterm Exam	1	160	160
	Final Exam	1	160	160

Schedule

Week	Date	Assigned Scripture Readings	Additional pre-class reading material	
1	Sep. 3	Intro to Course	Read syllabus	Upload personal introduction
2	Sep. 8	Alma 30-31	Selections from <i>Alma 30-63: A Brief Theological Introduction</i> by Mark A. Wrathall	
	Sep. 10	Alma 32-35		Proposal for Creative Discipleship Project Due
3	Sep. 15	Alma 36-37		
	Sep. 17	Alma 38-39		
4	Sep. 22	Alma 40-42		
	Sep. 24	Alma 43-51		
5	Sep. 29	Alma 52-63		Inspired Question Paper sources due
	Oct. 1	Helaman 1-5	"Introduction to Helaman" by Grant Hardy	
6	Oct. 6	Helaman 6-12		Inspired Question Paper Due
	Oct. 8	Helaman 13-16	Selections from <i>Helaman: A Brief Theological Introduction</i> by Kimberly Matheson Berkey	
7	Oct. 13	3 Nephi 1-5	"Introduction to 3 Nephi" by Grant Hardy	
	Oct. 15	3 Nephi 6-10		
8	Oct. 20	3 Nephi 11	Selections from <i>3-4 Nephi: A Brief Theological Introduction</i> by Daniel Becerra	
	Oct. 22	3 Nephi 12-14		
Oct. 22-24 Midterm on Learning Suite				
9	Oct. 27	3 Nephi 15-16		
	Oct. 29	3 Nephi 17		
10	Nov. 3	3 Nephi 18-19		
	Nov. 5	3 Nephi 20-26		
11	Nov. 10	3 Nephi 27-30		
	Nov. 12	4 Nephi – Mormon 6	"Introductions to 4 Nephi and Mormon" by Grant Hardy	
12	Nov. 17	Mormon 7-9	Selections from <i>Mormon: A Brief Theological Introduction</i> by Adam S. Miller	
	Nov. 19	Ether 1-6	"Introduction to Ether" by Grant Hardy	
13	Nov. 24	Ether 7-11		
14	Dec. 1	Ether 12-15	Selections from <i>Ether: A Brief Theological Introduction</i> by Rosalynde Frandsen Welch	Creative Discipleship Project due
	Dec. 3	Moroni 1-6	"Introduction to Moroni" by Grant Hardy	
15	Dec. 8	Moroni 7-10	Selections from <i>Moroni: A Brief Theological Introduction</i> by David F. Holland	
	Dec. 10	Concluding Thoughts with Creative Discipleship Projects	Bring your Project for peer reviews.	Student Evaluations
Dec. 12-17 Final Exam on Learning Suite				

Course Outcomes

- Articulate the basic structure, narrative, characters, and teachings of the Book of Mormon.
- Read sacred texts with greater curiosity, humility, honesty, and attentiveness. Ask meaningful questions of the text.
- Be able to teach others scriptural passages and concepts with humility, passion, and joy.

- Deepen an appreciation of Jesus Christ's redemptive role in God's plan and find confidence in God's expansive love for you and others.
- Navigate challenging questions with faith and optimism.
- Develop Christlike qualities and bless others through faithful living and service.

Each of these course outcomes ties in to one of the Aims of a BYU education to help this course be spiritually strengthening, intellectually enlarging, character developing, and leading to lifelong learning and service.

Detailed Assignment Descriptions

Before the second class, please submit a personal introduction in Learning Suite (in Class 1 Preparation Quiz).

Consistent Assignments (27 total combined scores; we drop the lowest)

You can find the **Attendance quizzes** (where during or at the end of each class you will account for *attendance* and *participation*) and the **Class Preparation reports** (where before each class you will account for *pre-reading* and time spent on *Creative Discipleship Project* and submit your *Deepening Study* activities and your *One Salient Question*) under the LS Exams tab or on the Schedule tab. You will self-report. God trusts you in remarkable ways, and so do I. Thank you for being honest and self-reflective as you do this.

Class Attendance (Up to 8 points per class)

Life is more enjoyable when we show up and engage with existence. Attendance and meaningful participation in class are essential to authentic learning. Participation and engagement may look different for introverts and extroverts. For full attendance points, you will need to attend the entirety of each class session.

A quiz will open at the beginning of each class and close at 1:10 PM, and I will give you the password to report your attendance. You will assign your own attendance points based on the rubric below. If you arrive late or leave early, multi-task with other homework, sleep, or do anything else that prevents you from being fully present and engaged with our discussion, subtract proportional points. This is an opportunity to practice attentiveness to what is. Assign points based on which statement below best describes your participation:

Attendance Points Rubric

- a. [8 pts.] I was fully engaged, curious, courageous, and attentive the whole time
- b. [6 pts.] I was actively engaged most of the time, or I was a little late
- c. [4 pts.] I was engaged about half of the time
- d. [2 pts.] I attended but did not really engage much with the class
- e. [0 pts.] I missed this class

Making up an excused absence: If you are sick or have a university-excused or other legitimate absence, please download the PowerPoint from Learning Suite (Content tab) and read through it (including presenter notes) and fill out the lecture guide. This will give you a sense of what we learned, and you may reach out to

me or the TAs for the attendance quiz password to take the quiz. Made-up attendance quizzes are worth 50% of possible points since this process provides at most half the learning experience of actually being there in person for discussions and lecture. Attending an extra-credit event will make up the other lost points.

Late attendance quizzes have a two-point deduction, so make sure to fill it out by the end of class.

Pre-class reading (Up to 4 points per class)

A desired outcome of this course is to help you engage meaningfully with the sacred text of the Book of Mormon. The class is designed to offer both breadth and depth of scriptural engagement. The breadth will come from reading all of the assigned scripture passages and additional readings.

Please *pre-read* the assigned material listed on the schedule so you come to class prepared to share insights and ask questions about what we are studying. Some of the assigned readings are short and some are considerably longer, so you may want to get ahead of the schedule if you want to level out the reading load.

Elder Jeffrey R. Holland invited us to “read more slowly and more carefully and with more questions in mind. . . . Ponder, examine every word, every scriptural gem. . . . Hold it up to the light, and turn it, look and see what’s reflected and refracted there” (1992 CES Satellite Broadcast, p. 4). You will not be able to read every assigned passage with this level of depth, attentiveness, and pondering, but Deepening Study Activities and writing One Salient Question per class will help you dive more deeply into passages that inspire or provoke you.

One Salient Question (1 point per class)

To help you read with curiosity, you will write down one salient or compelling question each class about which you would like further understanding, insight, or revelation. What do you wonder or want to know? This can be something you do not understand from the readings. It can be personal, scriptural, or doctrinal, but it should be inspired from your class reading. It can be earnest or whimsical. I will often read through these before class to guide my preparation for our discussions and lectures.

Deepening Study Activities (Entered in LS in Class Preparation report – 2 points per class)

Before each class you will engage in an activity designed to help you get more joy and insight out of your scripture study. We will focus on four specific skills this semester, each one for about two weeks at a time. The last several weeks of the semester, you will be free to choose which skill you would like to practice. Deepening study activities should directly relate to the assigned course readings.

Reflection Journal (weeks 2-3)

One reason we read scriptures is to open ourselves up to revelation. Elder Richard G. Scott taught, “Write down in a secure place the important things you learn from the Spirit. You will find that as you write down precious impressions, often more will come. Also, the knowledge you gain will be available throughout your life” (*Ensign*, June 2002). These first couple of weeks, you will keep a reflection journal as you read. Write your impressions, your musings, your wonderings, the connections you find within the scriptures and to your life. You can reflect on why the passages you study have meaning or interest to you. This is a free-form exercise, and you can find the format that works best for you. The idea is to read ready to receive and record impressions and insights.

Power Phrases (weeks 4-5)

These weeks will be all about internalizing a truth from the scriptures. For each class you will choose a “power phrase” to focus on from the assigned scripture reading. A power phrase could be as short as one word and as long as an entire verse. For example, from Nephi’s vision in 1 Nephi 11, I might choose the phrase, “the love of God . . . sheddeth itself abroad” (verse 22) or “What desirest thou?” (verse 10). After selecting a phrase, commit the phrase to memory. Maybe write it down somewhere where you will see it often or make it your screen saver. You may want to meditate on the phrase, repeating it with every in-breath and out-breath. Let it be your mantra or guiding image for a couple of days. This is a contemplative practice, designed to bring God’s word fully into your life. If I chose one of the phrases above, I might repeat it to myself as I looked at the mountains or clouds or into the eyes of students I pass on campus. Record your phrase for the class in the quiz, then write what you did to internalize it and what you experienced as you did.

Asking Questions (weeks 6-7)

James Faulconer writes that “questions about scripture help us think and ponder. . . . [F]ocusing on questions helps me come back to passages fresh, ready to learn new things as I read rather than returning to them with an implicit attitude of ‘I already know what this is about’” (*The Book of Mormon Made Harder*, x-xi). During weeks 6-7 we will practice reading with curiosity and a sense of humility and wonder. Each class, you will write down at least five questions that arise through your study. You do not need to be able to answer the questions. They can be about specific words in the text, about connections you sense, about implications for your life. No question is too big or too small: Why did Alma use that word? What is the connection between Alma and Korihor? How could hope be vain? Etc. Find joy in asking questions; it can help the scriptures come alive for you. You can copy and paste your favorite question for your salient question during these weeks.

Preparing to Teach (weeks 8-9)

You have likely noticed that when you prepare to teach or speak in church, you learn more. One desired outcome of this class is to help you become a better teacher of scripture. During weeks 8-9 you will imagine you have the chance to give a 3-5 minute lesson about something from the class readings. You may want to consider briefly explaining the context (what is going on in this passage?), examining specific words or phrases from the text (what lines strike you with fresh force?), focusing on a principle (what is the big truth here?), asking a relevant question (how does this apply or why does it matter?), and bearing testimony (why does it matter to *you*?). You can focus on one verse or on an entire scripture block. You will submit your lesson plan in LS. Bonus points these classes if you actually share it with someone outside of class! There is growth in the act of teaching or sharing.

Choose Your Own Study Activity (weeks 10-15)

For the final weeks of the semester, you can choose your own study activity—either one of the four we have practiced or another one of your choice. You will record in LS what you did and follow the instructions above if you choose one we’ve already practiced. If you choose your own, explain it and how it blessed you.

To encourage consistency and quality throughout the semester, the TAs will randomly select two of your entries and grade them based on the rubric below.

Random TA grading rubric for Deepening Study entries:

- [20 points] Student’s entry is thoughtful and clearly meets criteria for the week
- [15 points] Student has given thought to the entry, but it is short or lacking some criterion
- [10 points] The entry is missing fundamental criteria for the study activity
- [5 points] The entry reflects minimal effort or thought
- [0 points] Student did not turn in a Deepening Study Activity entry

There is no minimum word-count requirement, but you should write enough so we will be able to grade your entry on how well you met the rubric above. Even if you are not able to attend a given class, make an

entry based on your pre-readings for that class. If we randomly select an entry you skipped in LS, you will receive 0/20 points.

Creative Discipleship Project

God is a creator. As children of Heavenly Parents, we possess a spark of that divine creativity inside us. This project is an opportunity to awaken your curiosity and wonder and creativity. As disciples of Jesus Christ, we are invited to fill the world with light. For this project, you will create something inspired by your study of the Book of Mormon and/or your relationship with God. This can be art, music, poetry, film, creative writing, photography, etc. Or you could write a 4-6 page paper connecting your scripture study to your academic major (accounting majors could examine attitudes toward money in the Book of Mormon; poli-sci people could outline the political contours of a Zion society based on 4 Nephi; women's studies majors could consider Nephite and Lamanite attitudes toward women or the relative absence of women in Book of Mormon narratives, etc.). You could help create a better world by serving or teaching and documenting in a 2-3 page paper or a slideshow what you did and how your creative discipleship blessed you. This project is deliberately wide-open so that you can step into that space of creativity. Surprise me. Surprise yourself. You will be given points for working on your project at least one hour for each week during the term. Some of this will be thinking and ruminating. Don't be afraid of seeming false-starts.

Possible project ideas (the possibilities are as varied as the humans in this class):

Write the untold stories of minor characters in the Book of Mormon; paint your testimony; start a movement to eliminate -ites at BYU; form a book club that discusses contemporary issues of discipleship; write a rap inspired by one of your favorite BOM stories; etc.

To select a meaningful project, consider these questions: "What does my study of the Book of Mormon inspire me to do or create?" "How could I bring more of the light of Christ into this world?" "What am I already passionate about, and how could I invite God into that passion?" Pay attention to the nudges of creativity and insight that awaken your joy. Be sure to pick something you are excited about. If you ever lack motivation or your efforts begin to feel like busywork, please change your project. To do this, simply upload a new proposal in LS, email it to the TAs, and begin working on the new project right away.

Instructions:

Week 1: Begin thinking about what you would like to do.

Week 2 – SMART Proposal: Decide on a project and submit your proposal in LS under "Assignments," following the outline below. **Submit it as a .docx or .pdf file, please.** Your proposal is worth 3 points. It should essentially address these five areas (use this format if it helps):

S-Specific ~ What is your project? What tangible product (could be a paper) will you create in the process? *Be clear and precise.*

M-Measurable ~ How will you spend your assigned 60 minutes after each class? How will you know if you are meaningfully engaging in creative discipleship? How will you prevent your efforts from becoming busywork?

A-Attainable ~ How achievable is this project this semester? What milestones along the way will help you pace your efforts to finish what you set out to accomplish?

R-Rigorous ~ How will this project stretch you beyond what you would normally do anyway?

T-Timely ~ How relevant is this project for this time in your life? How will it help you grow and develop personally and fulfill our class objectives?

Weeks 3-13: Report in Preparation Report how many minutes you meaningfully worked on your project (1 point for each 15 minutes spent, up to a maximum of 2 points for 30 minutes per preparation report). If you get into a flow and spend more time one week, you may count that time for a future week.

Week 14: Creative Discipleship Project Report and Summary. Submit your project, creation, or paper in LS. If you created something physical, you can submit a picture of it. If you have a video or a large audio file, it is *very* helpful to upload it to YouTube or a drive first and just submit the link.

In addition to your project, please submit a brief report (at least one paragraph, at most one-page single-spaced) that includes the following:

- A brief **summary** of your project and your **desired objectives** in engaging with it this semester. What did you set out to do? (This will help your peers understand the essence of your project.)
- A report on how the experience **impacted you** and what you **learned** from it, including how it helped fulfill any of the **four aims** of a BYU education (spiritually-strengthening, intellectually-enlarging, character-developing, and leading to lifelong learning or service).
- Any other explanatory information you think would be helpful for a peer evaluating the project, including the disclosure any AI usage.

The TAs or I will grade this report and your project for 45 points. You will **complete a self-evaluation** for 20 points. During our last class period, we will have a day to celebrate our projects. Each student will bring their project and a printed copy of your brief summary to share with the class. (If you have a video or a song, you may want to upload it to YouTube or a similar platform and bring a printed QR code for your peers to scan.) You will be assigned to peer-review four other projects. **Peer reviews** will account for 20 points. After reviewing your assigned projects, you will be able to explore others' projects in a museum-style experience.

Week 15: Complete the class evaluation found at studentratings.byu.edu. The class evaluation will take the place of working on the project and submitting a Deepening Study activity and Salient Question for that class (worth 5 points).

Inspired Question Research Paper (One paper due at the end of week 6)

One of the objectives of this class is to learn to step toward and lean into our questions rather than fearing them. As a recent Church-produced document notes, "Inspired questions should be considered gifts from God that provide opportunities for us to increase our understanding" (*Doctrinal Mastery Core Document*). This assignment gives you the opportunity to wrestle with a meaningful question that arises from your study of the Book of Mormon *or* from your life of discipleship. It is worth 110 points. Submit your paper in Microsoft .docx or .pdf format. Seek the Lord's guidance so your research and writing will be relevant and meaningful to you. Papers should be 4-6 pages in length (Use 12-point Times New Roman font, double spacing, and default 1" margins). If you miss the paper deadline, you may turn it in late with a 5-point/day penalty. If it is more than 11 days late, you can turn it in for up to 50% of the original points possible.

****Things to include on a cover page *before* the body of your paper
(not included in the 4-6-page count)**

- Your **name** and **section**
- Your **inspired question** or **paper title**
- A bulleted list of the **sources** you studied in the research phase, **categorized by type** (scriptures, church-related sources, and academic sources). This is your Works Cited page. You can use any format you prefer (Chicago, MLA, APA, etc.) when listing academic sources. For scriptures, simply cite book and chapter. For Conference talks, give speaker's name, title and date of talk, and a link to the talk.
- A **disclosure of any AI usage** in researching, writing, or editing the paper. Make sure AI use does not preclude you from accomplishing the purposes of the paper or replace the authentic process for you.

Writing the paper

Questions naturally arise as we study the scriptures and strive to live lives of devoted discipleship. Pay attention to your questions. Honor them. They can lead you into a deeper relationship with our Heavenly Parents. For this paper: (1) choose a question that stirs your soul, awakens your curiosity, or that you or someone you know wrestles with about the gospel, the scriptures, or the Church; (2) ponder and seek out reliable sources of information that will help you find answers or at least a direction for thinking about your question, and then (3) report what you learned, what process you used to seek truth, and what epiphanies and insights you gained along the way.

Some essential steps (we will grade according to these guidelines):

1. Study any three scripture passages from different chapters that are related to your inspired question. At least one of these passages should be from the Book of Mormon [**3 points per chapter = 9 points**]*
2. Study a total of three different Church-related articles, talks, or book chapters directly related to your question in any of the following sources: [**6 points for each source = 18 pts.**]*
 - General Conference Talks (you can use scriptures.byu.edu to help find relevant talks)
 - *Liahona/Ensign* or *For Strength of Youth* / *New Era* Magazine articles
 - churchofjesuschrist.org/study/manual/gospel-topics
 - speeches.byu.edu
 - Devotional books written by Church leaders
3. Seek answers or insights to your question from three articles or chapters you find in any of the following (or other) academic sources: [**6 points per article studied = 18 pts.*** You can enter key words or phrases in each site's search engine to find relevant material]
 - rsc.byu.edu
 - mi.byu.edu
 - scholarsarchive.byu.edu/byusq/
 - scripturecentral.org
 - fairmormon.org/find-answers
 - Other reliable source you trust and that resonates with you

***1/3 of these points will be awarded the week before the paper is due when you turn in just your sources.** You will need to include your cover page and sources with the final paper submission as well.

4. Report the results of your study by writing a 4-6-page paper. Your paper should be well thought-out and well-written. It should synthesize elements of what you learned (no lengthy quotes) from all the steps in

your research (#1-3 above). You do not need to quote all of the sources you consult in the body of your paper. Points will be subtracted for sloppy writing. Include the following in your paper [up to 55 points]:

- a. **[0-10 pts.]** What inspired **question** did you research? Why was this question **personally relevant** to you? What were your initial **assumptions** and conclusions about that question before doing any of this research?
 - b. **[0-5 pts.]** Give a brief description of the **processes** you used to find helpful material in steps 1-3. You might briefly explain why you chose the specific articles you selected over others.
 - c. **[0-30 pts.]** Give a detailed explanation of **what you discovered** from this research. How would you now answer your initial question? Which of your previous assumptions were validated? Which were called into question because of what you learned? How confident are you in the answers you found? What parts of your question are still unclear or unanswered? What does faith look like for you in the face of potential continued uncertainty?
 - d. **[0-10 pts.]** What did you learn about **the process of seeking truth** using the various sources listed in parts 2 and 3? What did you find most or least helpful, enjoyable, or inspiring with these sites? Might this be different with a different type of question?
 - e. **[0-10 pts.]** How will this experience of leaning into your questions and this new knowledge **help you in your life moving forward**? How will you continue to apply a faithful practice of seeking insight and answers? What new questions do you have now that you completed this research?
-

Exams (taken on your honor online in Learning Suite)

Tests are **open-scripture**, and you can use any **notes in your scriptures**. I encourage you to take notes directly in your scriptures since they are more likely to last that way. You may use digital scriptures, but you may **not use the search function**. I upload **lecture guides** to LS before each class under the Content tab. You may **not use the lecture guides** during the test, but these are your best study guides. Most test questions will come from what we cover in class, and a few will come from the pre-reading assignments. Tests are multiple choice, T/F, and matching of the names of people with their descriptions. There will also be the option of taking a version of the test with open-ended short essay responses instead of multiple choice. This often takes longer, and the test average is the same, but it has clear advantages and improved learning outcomes for some students.

The midterm will include material from the first half of the course. The final will follow the same format with emphasis on the second half of the semester, along with a few comprehensive questions. If a test average is lower than 84%, I will raise everyone's score until it reaches that threshold. Small study groups and reviewing notes, lecture guides, or class PPTs are often effective methods for test-prep.

Other Items to Know

This Syllabus

A syllabus is a contract between teachers and students. If you ever have questions about assignments, due dates, or expectations in the course, read the syllabus first. Many times, you will find the answer here. Occasionally, the need arises to amend the syllabus or adjust course expectations. This will be done through class announcements and emails from me or the TAs.

Members of Other Faiths or New Members of the Church

Please contact me early in the term so I can make sure you do not fall behind due to a lack of exposure to the teachings we will read and discuss.

Late Adds

Follow the instructions given in the contents tab of LS within one week of adding the course to regain lost points.

Extra Credit

I will announce extra credit opportunities throughout the semester. You may attend up to 5 events for extra credit. You will enter your attendance and reflections on the event in Learning Suite.

University Statement on Belonging

We are united by our common primary identity as children of God (Acts 17:29; Psalm 82:6) and our commitment to the truths of the restored gospel of Jesus Christ (BYU Mission Statement). We strive to create a community of belonging composed of students, faculty, and staff whose hearts are knit together in love (Mosiah 18:21) where:

- *All relationships reflect devout love of God and a loving, genuine concern for the welfare of our neighbor (BYU Mission Statement);*
- *We value and embrace the variety of individual characteristics, life experiences and circumstances, perspectives, talents, and gifts of each member of the community and the richness and strength they bring to our community (1 Corinthians 12:12–27);*
- *Our interactions create and support an environment of belonging (Ephesians 2:19); and*
- *The full realization of each student's divine potential is our central focus (BYU Mission Statement).*

Review the "Key University Policies" document under the "Content" tab of LS.

This document contains important information regarding the Honor Code, Sexual Harassment, Student Disability, Academic Honesty, Deliberation Guidelines, Devotional Attendance, Inappropriate Use of Course Materials, Mental Health, Plagiarism, and Maintaining a Respectful Environment

Honesty and Integrity

One of the Aims of a BYU Education is to help you develop your character. This is hard to measure or quantify. One way you can demonstrate that particular goal is by being honest in how you self-report your scores. Please let me know if you have any questions or concerns about any assignment or score.

Learning Suite

Everything for this class will be entered and tracked on learningsuite.byu.edu. Please do not use the global messaging system for things not related to this class.

University Accessibility Center

Brigham Young University is committed to providing a working and learning atmosphere that reasonably accommodates qualified persons with disabilities. A disability is a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities. Whether an impairment is substantially limiting depends on its nature and severity, its duration or expected duration, and its permanent or expected permanent or long-term impact. Examples include vision or hearing impairments, physical disabilities, chronic illnesses, emotional disorders (e.g., depression, anxiety), learning disorders, and attention disorders (e.g., ADHD).

If you have a disability which impairs your ability to complete this course successfully, please contact the University Accessibility Center (UAC), 2170 WSC or 801-422-2767 to request a reasonable academic accommodation. The UAC can also assess students for learning, attention, and emotional concerns. If you feel you have been unlawfully discriminated against on the basis of disability, please contact the Equal Employment Office at 801-422-5895, D-285 ASB for help.

Mental Health Resources

"One in four people in the world will be affected by mental illness at some point in their lives. More than 16 million U.S. adults had at least one major depressive episode in the past year"

(<https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/study/manual/mental-health-general-principles/2-like-a-broken->

[vessel](#)). The [situation] at BYU mirrors national trends, with higher rates of anxiety and depression being reported than ever before.... [Furthermore,] we have an especially high degree of self-defeating perfectionism in our student body” (<https://magazine.byu.edu/article/finding-mental-health-help-on-campus/>).

“Everyone has days when they feel sad, stressed, anxious, or overwhelmed by life’s challenges. If you continue to struggle for several weeks or longer or your symptoms begin interfering with your daily life, seek help. Talk to someone you trust. Addressing mental health concerns early and often is the most effective approach and can help prevent a crisis in the future. There are a variety of factors that affect feelings, thoughts, mood, and behavior. Struggling with your mental health does not indicate a weakness in your character or spirit” (<https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/study/manual/mental-health-help-for-me/1-how-can-i-tell>).

BYU Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS, 1500 WSC, 801-422-3035, caps.byu.edu) provides individual, couples, and group counseling, as well as stress management services. These services are confidential and are provided by the university at no cost for full-time students. For general information please visit <https://caps.byu.edu>; for more immediate concerns please visit <http://help.byu.edu>.